

continue to exist long past their sell-by dates. No matter how outlandish, once these ideas find an audience, it takes a long while for them to go away. Recall what Max Planck, who won the Nobel Prize in 1918 for originating quantum theory, famously observed: “Truth never triumphs—its opponents just die out. Science advances one funeral at a time.”



We are all too easily ensnared by bad ideas. Before we dive deeper into the “why,” let’s consider how we can shift our perspectives on this sophistry.

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As I detailed in: Barry Ritholtz, *Bailout Nation: How Greed and Easy Money Corrupted Wall Street and Shook the World Economy* (Wiley, 2009).